Uriel N. Galace

uriel.galace@duke.edu | urielgalace.github.io | linkedin.com/in/galaceuriel

Career Summary

Ph.D. Candidate at Duke University. I study political economy, political institutions, and economic development. My goal is to understand how institutions, governance, and political incentives shape differences in development outcomes among nations, as well as identify policy solutions to help narrow these differences.

Education

Duke University — Durham, NC
Ph.D., Public Policy; M.A., Economics — *Aug. 2022 – Present*

Field: Political Economy | Policy Area: International Development

- Dissertation: *"When Enough is Enough: Corruption, Brazenness, and Collective Action"*

University of Notre Dame — South Bend, IN
Master of Global Affairs, Sustainable Development — *May 2021*

- Recipient of the Liu Institute Fellowship (full tuition scholarship and stipend).

Ateneo de Manila University — Manila, Philippines
A.B., Political Science; Minor in English Literature — *June 2016*

- Candidate for valedictorian; candidate for Political Science Program Award; top 5% of a graduating class of almost 2,000 students.

Additional Education

Stanford University Online and DeepLearning.AI — Online
Specalization: Machine Learning — *August 2026*

- Relevant courses: Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification; Advanced Learning Algorithms; Unsupervised Learning, Recommenders, Reinforcement Learning.

MITx MicroMasters — Online
Certificate: Data, Economics, and Development Policy — *June 2022*

- Relevant courses: Microeconomics; Data Analysis for Social Scientists; Foundations of Development Policy: Advanced Development Economics; Political Economy and Economic Development; Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations.

University of Newcastle — Newcastle, Australia
Junior Term Abroad — *July 2014 – Dec. 2014*

- Joined intercultural activities, including intercultural festivals and exhibitions, food fairs, and the like. Participated in the university's International Leadership (iLEAD) Program and attended skills-building workshops.

Work Experience

Economic Research and Development Impact Intern — June 2026 – Aug. 2026
Asian Development Bank — *Manila, Philippines*

- Conducted research on a background paper for the *Asian Development Policy Report 2027*, examining household resilience to economic shocks across five longitudinal household panels covering Indonesia, Thailand, Viet Nam, the People's Republic of China, and the Kyrgyz Republic.
- Constructed harmonized measures of household resilience in Stata and Python covering 11,992 households across surveys differing in panel length, welfare measures, and shock instruments.
- Presented findings at an ADB Economists' Brown Bag seminar attended by 33 participants and developed recommendations for extending the analysis and applying it to policy targeting.

Research Assistant — Aug. 2023 – Mar. 2024; Oct. 2025 – Present
Duke University, Sanford School of Public Policy — *Durham, NC*

- Developed agentic AI research protocols to identify employer locations in 13,673 historical NLRB union elections, assigning counties to 90% of cases through confidence scoring, source documentation, and manual verification.

- Worked on a World Bank-assisted project regarding recentralization in Vietnam. Applied data analysis and replication techniques to validate and extend previous research findings.

Teaching Assistant Aug. 2023 – Present

Duke University, Sanford School of Public Policy *Durham, NC*

- Served as a teaching assistant for the undergraduate courses *Introduction to Public Policy Analysis*, *Microeconomic Tools for Policy Analysis*, and *Economics of the Public Sector*.
- Served as a teaching assistant for the graduate courses *Empirical Analysis for Economic Development* and *Microeconomics and Policymaking*.

Visiting Researcher May 2025 – Aug. 2025

Ateneo School of Government *Manila, Philippines*

- Designed and led a 68-interview governance study across four Philippine municipalities and Metro Manila, engaging senior government officials, mayors, contractors, journalists, civil society leaders, academics, and ordinary residents.

Policy Intern June 2023 – Aug. 2023

Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA) *Manila, Philippines*

- Supported the policy team in engaging policy partners, creating dissemination materials, and collaborating closely with the research teams at IPA.
- Assisted in reviewing and developing IPA Philippines sector briefs and translating research evidence into concise messages for policymakers.
- Contributed to projects such as scaling up the mEducation program and supporting project partnerships and development, gaining hands-on experience in policy engagement and communication strategy development.

Research Associate Aug. 2021 – June 2022

University of Notre Dame, Keough School of Global Affairs *South Bend, IN*

- Conducted quantitative analysis across five development economics projects spanning Guatemala, India, Mexico, and Sri Lanka.
- Cleaned and analyzed economic and survey data in Stata; translated results into regression tables, visualizations, and maps to support research findings and policy recommendations.
- Programmed and managed surveys in SurveyCTO and performed data quality checks throughout the research process.

Teaching Assistant Feb. 2021 – May 2021

University of Notre Dame, Keough School of Global Affairs *South Bend, IN*

- Served as a teaching assistant for the graduate course in Quantitative Methods.

Graduate Consultant Nov. 2019 – Nov. 2020

Chemonics International *Washington, D.C. (Remote)*

- Worked as part of a 4-student consulting team to improve development outcomes by identifying ways to increase engagement between the private sector and international development sector.
- Produced deliverables including seven private sector engagement case studies, a feasibility study, a 6-page report, and a white paper to support 65 country missions working on health supply chains.
- Led work on deliverables for the South Africa VukaNow and Philippines E-PESO and DELIVER projects.
- Conducted 70 interviews across 42 countries and 28 projects, created surveys, and presented findings to both Chemonics and the University of Notre Dame.

Small Business Consultant Aug. 2020 – Nov. 2020

South Bend Entrepreneurship and Adversity Program *South Bend, IN*

- Provided consulting services to two disadvantaged businesses in South Bend, Indiana, formalizing both business models and producing six deliverables.
- Built a lawn care company's first website, a promotional video, and a customer database with route-planning recommendations.
- Co-designed a lead triage system for a brand coaching firm, informed by interviews with its past and current clients.

Foreign Affairs Research Specialist I & II Nov. 2016 – Aug. 2019

Center for International Relations and Strategic Studies (CIRSS) *Manila, Philippines*
Foreign Service Institute, Department of Foreign Affairs

Research

- Monitored international security and economic developments for the American and European desks, examined implications for the Philippines, and wrote policy papers with recommendations.
- Published four international affairs commentaries from Dec. 2016 to Apr. 2018 (average of 1.2 for other researchers in the same time span).
- Helped organize and write reports on international conferences, including four high-level forums included in the Philippines' hosting of ASEAN in 2017.

Training & Events

- Hosted six and attended 40 lectures delivered by visiting scholars and practitioners, gaining exposure to the latest research and best practices.
- Attended 23 training programs by the Foreign Service Institute Philippines, including four modules of the Cadetship Course for Foreign Service Officers.
- Received an average performance rating of 4.86 / 5.00 from supervisors, one of the highest among researchers.

Researcher Aug. 2016 – Oct. 2016

PAMPUBLIKO (For the Public) *Manila, Philippines*

- Published six articles, including background briefings on the South China Sea dispute, extremism in the southern Philippines, and Philippine foreign policy; reached 140,000+ people across 45 countries through Facebook and achieved 4,500+ likes.
- Reported on four conferences for PAMPUBLIKO's Facebook and Twitter accounts.
- Performed fact-checking, copy-editing, social media content analysis, and other administrative tasks, supporting day-to-day operations.

Intern for Campaign Coordination and Management June 2016 – July 2016

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) *Manila, Philippines*

- Audited UNHCR Philippines' Facebook page and delivered a presentation assessing performance and recommending steps to improve organic engagement.
- Designed email newsletters for donors through MailChimp, produced Click-to-Website ads for the refugee campaign on Facebook, and created content for the *"With You"* monthly newsletter.
- Helped organize a World Refugee Day forum on international refugee law at the Polytechnic University of the Philippines College of Law.

Intern for Resilience and Peacebuilding June 2015 – July 2015

United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) *Manila, Philippines*

- Produced a report on the Mindanao conflict—tracing its history, profiling extremist groups involved, and outlining the Bangsamoro Basic Law.
- Designed a Project Map highlighting the location of five key projects.
- Created an Office-in-a-Box, compiling 15 core documents needed for UNDP emergency response initiatives and program start-ups.

Volunteer Experience

Volunteer Oct. 11–21, 2016

International Campaign to Abolish Nuclear Weapons (ICAN) *New York, NY*

- Supported ICAN as it lobbied for passage of the United Nations Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons during General Assembly sessions at the UN Secretariat in New York.

Liaison Volunteer Nov. 16–18, 2015

Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC) CEO Summit *Manila, Philippines*

- Coordinated with journalists from CNN, BBC, and other outlets to set up speaker interviews and provide official photos and press releases.
- Performed logistics work in the Plenary Hall, observing speeches of Xi Jinping and other world leaders on trade and economic policies.

Scholarships Awarded

- Public Policy Fellowship, Duke University, Sanford School of Public Policy
- Liu Institute Fellowship, University of Notre Dame, Keough School of Global Affairs
- Ayala Scholarship Fund, Harvard University, Kennedy School of Government *(declined)*
- Dean's Scholarship, Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies *(declined)*
- Fletcher Scholarship, Tufts University, Fletcher School of Law and Diplomacy *(declined)*
- Sié Fellowship, University of Denver, Korbel School of International Studies *(declined)*

Awards Received

Best Writing Prize, Center for Philippine Studies June 2025

2025 SPAS Graduate Student Conference, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa *Honolulu, HI*

- Awarded for the paper *"The Differential Impact of Colonization Within Countries: Evidence from the Philippines,"* recognized for its scholarly merit, analytical depth, and contribution to Philippine Studies.

Winner, Case Study Competition (Security and Diplomacy Panel) Aug. 2015

Harvard Project for Asian and International Relations (HPAIR) Asia Conference *Manila, Philippines*

- Led an international team composed of Chinese, Japanese, Singaporean, and Vietnamese delegates to win the Security and Diplomacy Case Study Competition.
- Compiled and edited a position paper on the Syrian Civil War; served as chief negotiator for the delegation acting as the United States in simulated negotiations.

Training Courses & Certifications

Training Course / Certification	Details
Project Management for Development Professional by PM4NGOs	30 hours of study. Project DPro Foundation examination passed on April 15, 2025.
Statistics for Policy Analysis by the Philippine Statistical Research and Training Institute	1 week of training, 40 hours training credit. Course completed on November 9, 2018.
Foreign Service Officers' Cadetship Course: Module on Economic Diplomacy	1 week of training, 20 hours total. Course completed on August 10, 2018.
Course on Public Diplomacy	2 weeks of study, 28 hours training credit. Course completed on May 23, 2018.
Foreign Service Officers' Cadetship Course: Module on Arts Management	1 week of training, 8 hours / day. Course completed on February 23, 2018.
Foreign Service Officers' Cadetship Course: Module on Protocol, Diplomatic Decorum, and Conference Management	3 days of training, 8 hours / day. Course completed on October 18, 2017.
Course on Basic Statistics by the Philippine Statistical Research and Training Institute	2 days of study, 12 hours training credit. Course completed on September 26, 2017.
Cultural Officers' Course: Cultural Diplomacy by the Foreign Service Institute Philippines	2 weeks of study, 62 hours training credit. Course completed on September 1, 2017.
The Philippine and Russian Relations by the Presidential Commission on Visiting Forces	1/2 day program. Certificate earned on August 30, 2017.
Foreign Service Officers' Cadetship Course: Module on Diplomacy	1 week of study, 29.5 hours training credit. Course completed on July 12, 2017.
Strategic Studies Workshop by the Armed Forces of the Philippines	1 1/2 day program. Certificate earned on June 30, 2017.
Course Series on Statistics and Foreign Policy Analysis and Research by the Foreign Service Institute Philippines	2 days of training, 8 hours / day. Course completed on November 10, 2016.
Action for Disarmament at the UN by Peace Boat Global University	2-day program in New York City, USA. Certificate earned on October 21, 2016.
Capacity Training on Public Speaking and Negotiation by the Asia-Europe Foundation	1 day of training. Course completed on June 27, 2016.

Online Course Certifications

Course Title	Details
Unsupervised Learning, Recommenders, Reinforcement Learning by Stanford University Online and DeepLearning.AI	3 weeks of study, approximately 8–11 hours / week. Course completed on August 21, 2026.
Advanced Learning Algorithms by DeepLearning.AI and Stanford University on Coursera	4 weeks of study, approximately 7–11 hours / week. Course completed on July 29, 2026.
Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification by DeepLearning.AI and Stanford University on Coursera	4 weeks of study, 7–16 hours / week. Course completed on January 12, 2026.

Course Title	Details
Introduction to Statistical Learning by Stanford University on edX	11 weeks of study, 3–5 hours / week. Course completed on July 17, 2024.
Introduction to Stata 15 on LinkedIn Learning	4 hours of study. Course completed on September 9, 2021.
From Poverty to Prosperity: Understanding Economic Development by the University of Oxford on edX	6 weeks of study, 2–3 hours / week. Course completed on June 3, 2021.
Introduction to Corporate Finance by the University of Pennsylvania on Coursera	4 weeks of study, 3–5 hours / week. Course completed on May 30, 2018.
The Age of Sustainable Development by Columbia University on Coursera	14 weeks of study, 2 hours / week. Course completed on May 28, 2018.
Introduction to Financial Accounting by the University of Pennsylvania on Coursera	4 weeks of study, 5–6 hours / week. Course completed on May 11, 2018.
Inferential Statistics by the University of Amsterdam on Coursera	7 weeks of study, 1–3 hours / week. Course completed on April 16, 2018.
Inferential Statistics for R by the University of Amsterdam on DataCamp	7 weeks of study, 1–3 hours / week. Course completed on April 5, 2018.
Calculus One by Ohio State University on Coursera	16 weeks of study. Course completed on January 6, 2018.
Economics of Money and Banking by Columbia University on Coursera	13 weeks of study, 5 hours / week. Course completed on November 6, 2017.
Financial Markets (with Honors) by Yale University on Coursera	7 weeks of study, 3–4 hours / week. Course completed on August 21, 2017.
Pre-Calculus: Trigonometry by the University of California, Irvine on Coursera	9 weeks of study. Course completed on June 21, 2017.
Pre-Calculus: Functions by the University of California, Irvine on Coursera	8 weeks of study. Course completed on June 15, 2017.
Basic Statistics by the University of Amsterdam on Coursera	8 weeks of study, week 1: 3–6 hours; week 2: 1–3 hours / week. Course completed on April 18, 2017.
Basic Statistics for R by the University of Amsterdam on DataCamp	8 weeks of study, week 1: 3–6 hours; week 2: 1–3 hours / week. Course completed on April 13, 2017.
The Power of Macroeconomics: Economic Principles in the Real World by the University of California, Irvine on Coursera	13 weeks of study, 13 hours of video and quizzes. Course completed on June 15, 2017.
Microeconomics Principles by the University of Illinois at Urbana–Champaign on Coursera	8 weeks of study. Course completed on October 24, 2016.
Advanced Security in the Field by the United Nations Department of Safety and Security	1–2 hours of training. Course completed on June 15, 2016.
Basic Security in the Field II by the United Nations Department of Safety and Security	2 modules. Course completed on June 15, 2016.

Conference/Workshop Presentations

- Philippine Political Science Association International Conference (Apr. 28–30, 2026)
- University of North Carolina Bringing Southeast Asia Home Workshop (April 19, 2026)
- Duke University Asian/Pacific Studies Institute Forum (Nov. 7, 2025)
- Philippine Political Science Association International Conference (May 23–24, 2025)
- Association of Southeast Asian Studies UK International PhD Workshop (May 20–21, 2025)
- University of Wisconsin-Madison Southeast Asian Studies Graduate Workshop (Apr. 24–26, 2025)
- University of Hawaii at Manoa School of Pacific and Asian Studies Annual Graduate Student Conference (Apr. 16–17)
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (Apr. 3–6, 2025)
- Asian Political and International Studies Association 2023 Annual Congress (June 30–July 1, 2023)

International Conferences Attended

- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (Sep. 3–6, 2026)
- Southeast Asia Research Group 2025 Winter Conference (Dec. 4–6, 2025)
- International Academic Forum Asian Conference on the Social Sciences (May 23–27, 2024)
- Southeast Asia Research Group 2023 Winter Conference (Dec. 7–9, 2023)
- Southeast Asia Research Group 2023 Summer Conference (July 31–Aug. 2, 2023)
- World Bank Annual Meeting 2022 (Oct. 10, 2022)
- Development Day 2021 (Dec. 4, 2021)
- Building Sustainable Peace: Ideas, Evidence, Strategies (Nov. 8–10, 2019)
- Manila Conference 2019: Pathways to Peace and Development (July 10–11, 2019)
- The Future of the US–Philippines Bilateral Relationship (Feb. 6–8, 2019)
- China–Philippines Business Forum (Nov. 26, 2018)
- Imagining a New Asian Order 2020–2035: Implications for Security, Economics, and Democracy (Oct. 27–28, 2018)
- FES National Workshop on Violent Extremism in the Philippines (Sep. 8, 2018)
- Reaping the Benefits of the PH–EU Partnership Cooperation Agreement (Aug. 29, 2018)
- Challenges to a Rules-Based International Order (Aug. 17, 2018)
- The PH Government's Anti-Drug Campaign: Emerging Evidence & Data (June 25, 2018)
- Endless Discovery: Re-evaluating Japan's Travel and Tourism (Feb. 2–3, 2018)
- Colloquium on International Law (Dec. 4, 2017)
- ASEAN Leadership Amidst a New World Order (Nov. 8, 2017)
- The High Level Forum on ASEAN @ 50 (Oct. 19, 2017)
- EU–Philippines Business Summit (Oct. 17, 2017)
- 4th Network of ASEAN–China Think Tanks (Oct. 5, 2017)
- The Global Conference of Heads of Posts (Jan. 30–Feb. 3, 2017)
- The Philippines' Chairmanship of ASEAN (Jan. 24, 2017)
- Asserting ASEAN's role in the Regional Order (Nov. 28, 2016)
- Towards a Shared Prosperity: Building Synergies in Competitiveness and Development (Oct. 24, 2016)
- Public Forum on Governance: Realising Changes that Work (Sep. 16, 2016)
- Renewing the Multilateral Response: Building an ASEAN Coalition (July 19, 2016)

Affiliations

- American Political Science Association (June 2026 – Present)
- Midwest Political Science Association (Oct. 2024 – Present)
- Southeast Asia Research Group (Apr. 2023 – Present)
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (Aug. 2025 – Aug. 2026)
- Duke Alumni Philippines (May 2023 – Present)
- Notre Dame Alumni Club of the Philippines (May 2020 – Present)
- Philippine International Studies Organization (May 2017 – Aug. 2019)
- Young Southeast Asian Leaders Initiative (Feb. 2016 – Present)
- Mensa International (Oct. 2014 – Sep. 2017)

Working Papers

- *"Do Political Dynasties Lead to Greater Poverty? Evidence From the Philippines."* Presented at the 2025 Philippine Political Science Association International Conference.
- *"Does Good Governance Reduce Corruption? Evidence From the Philippines"* Presented at the Association of Southeast Asian Studies UK International PhD Workshop and Duke University Asian/Pacific Studies Institute Forum.
- *"The Differential Impact of Colonization Within Countries: Evidence from the Philippines."* Presented at the 2025 Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference and 2025 SPAS Graduate Student Conference, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa.
- *"The Colonial Origins of Comparative Development: An Empirical Investigation: Revision."* Working paper.
- *"Housing Insecurity and Economic Development: A Case Study of Informal Settlements in Manila, Philippines."* Presented at the Asian Political and International Studies Association 2023 Annual Congress.

Other Works in Progress

- *"Machine Learning Feature Selection and Causal Analysis of Philippine Municipal Outcomes."*
- *"Deep Historical Determinants of Economic Development."*
- *"Appointed Versus Elected Government in the Bangsamoro."*

Policy Publications

- *"Effective policies for addressing economic inequality."* Keough School of Global Affairs, *Dignity & Development.* 2020.
- *"On economic inequality and human dignity."* Keough School of Global Affairs, *Dignity & Development.* 2020.
- *"Why Is the Philippines Pivoting Towards China?"* PAMPUBLIKO, 2018.
- *"Examining the Prospects of Enhanced PH–Russian Relations."* PAMPUBLIKO, 2018.
- *"How Does Germany's New Coalition Government Affect the Philippines?"* CIRSS Commentaries, 2018.
- *"Does the Philippines Need the EU's GSP+?"* CIRSS Commentaries, 2018.
- *"Top 5 Most Competitive ASEAN Nations."* ProspectsASEAN, 2017.
- *"Why Should Filipinos Care About the French Presidential Election?"* CIRSS Commentaries, 2017.
- *"Assessing Obama's Asia Rebalancing Strategy."* CIRSS Commentaries, 2016.
- *"Background Briefing – South China Sea Dispute."* PAMPUBLIKO, 2016.
- *"Conflict in Mindanao and the Ongoing Peace Process."* PAMPUBLIKO, 2016.

Skills

Language: Fluent in English and Filipino. Working proficiency in Spanish (B1).
Computer: Stata, R/RStudio, Python, Qualtrics, SurveyCTO, Tableau, LaTeX
Methods: Agentic AI, machine learning, applied econometrics